

Math 241, F14
Quiz 2

Name: Answer
SSN: xxx-xx-

Instructions: There are totally 2 problems. You must show all of your work to receive a credit for a correct answer. No calculator is allowed in the quiz.

Problem 1. (6 points) Given two vectors $\mathbf{a} = \langle 3, -2, 6 \rangle$ and $\mathbf{b} = \langle 4, 0, 3 \rangle$.

(a) Find the angle between $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$.

$$\begin{aligned} |\mathbf{a}| &= \sqrt{3^2 + (-2)^2 + 6^2} = \sqrt{49} = 7 \\ |\mathbf{b}| &= \sqrt{4^2 + 0^2 + 3^2} = \sqrt{25} = 5 \\ \mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b} &= 3 \cdot 4 + (-2) \cdot 0 + 6 \cdot 3 = 30 \\ \Rightarrow \cos \theta &= \frac{\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b}}{|\mathbf{a}| |\mathbf{b}|} = \frac{30}{5 \cdot 7} = \frac{30}{35} = \frac{6}{7} \Rightarrow \theta = \cos^{-1}\left(\frac{6}{7}\right) \end{aligned}$$

(b) Find the vector projection of $\mathbf{b}$ onto $\mathbf{a}$, $\text{proj}_{\mathbf{a}} \mathbf{b}$.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Proj}_{\mathbf{a}} \mathbf{b} &= \left(\frac{\mathbf{a} \cdot \mathbf{b}}{|\mathbf{a}|^2} \right) \mathbf{a} \\ &= \left(\frac{30}{7^2} \right) \langle 3, -2, 6 \rangle \\ &= \left\langle \frac{90}{49}, -\frac{60}{49}, \frac{180}{49} \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Problem 2. (4 points) Compute the cross product $\mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b}$ where $\mathbf{a} = 2\mathbf{i} - 3\mathbf{j} + 7\mathbf{k}$ and $\mathbf{b} = \mathbf{i} + 4\mathbf{j} - 2\mathbf{k}$.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{a} \times \mathbf{b} &= \begin{vmatrix} \mathbf{i} & \mathbf{j} & \mathbf{k} \\ 2 & -3 & 7 \\ 1 & 4 & -2 \end{vmatrix} = \mathbf{i} \begin{vmatrix} -3 & 7 \\ 4 & -2 \end{vmatrix} - \mathbf{j} \begin{vmatrix} 2 & 7 \\ 1 & -2 \end{vmatrix} + \mathbf{k} \begin{vmatrix} 2 & -3 \\ 1 & 4 \end{vmatrix} \\ &= \mathbf{i}(6 - 28) - \mathbf{j}(-4 - 7) + \mathbf{k}(8 - (-3)) \\ &= -22\mathbf{i} + 11\mathbf{j} + 11\mathbf{k} \end{aligned}$$